



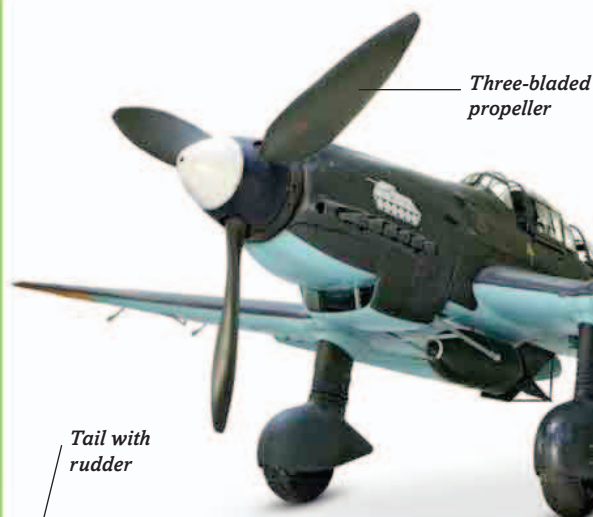
Strike force



Wooden wing frame
covered in canvas

Avro 504 UK 1913

Tail skid helps
slow aircraft down
while landing



Three-bladed
propeller

Junkers Ju87 Stuka Germany 1935



Electronics in tail to
confuse enemy radar and
detect incoming missiles



Boeing B-17G Flying Fortress USA 1935

Chin turret manned
by bombardier who
also aims the bombs



Heinkel He111
Germany 1940

Top speed
of 270 mph (434 km/h)



Exhausts to release gases from
the Rolls Royce Merlin engine

de Havilland DH98
Mosquito UK 1940

Fuel tanks in
wings and body

The
B-2 Spirit is
the world's most
expensive aircraft,
costing **\$2.1
billion**
each!



Strike aircraft attack ground targets using bombs or missiles. The first bombers were regular planes from which small bombs were dropped by hand. Special bombers were developed at the end of World War I and saw major action in World War II.

Some World War II bombers, such as the **Junkers Ju87 Stuka**, would dive low to bomb enemy forces on the ground. Others operated from high altitude, as much as 29,528 ft (9,000 m) in the case of the **Boeing B-17G Flying Fortress**. The **Avro Lancaster** had over double the bomb-carrying